abortive Jewish state," the situation of world Jewry would remain unchanged.[23]

This view was partly shared by the late Maxime Rodinson (a well-known Arabist from a working-class Jewish family) who prefaced the 1968 French edition of Léon's book. Rodinson was more insightful than Léon about Zionism and antisemitism, but hostile to the Zionist Jews as "a foreign people [who] had come and imposed itself on a native population" [the Arabs] as part of a broader European-American movement of expansion in the 19th and 20th centuries.[24] Typically, in Rodinson's account of the Middle East conflict, there is no Jewish historical specificity, only the perverse determination of colonialist invaders to create a separate civilization in Palestine. As for the Arabs, they had every reason to reject "foreign domination" and resist the Zionist "colonialist" *fait accompli* which had emerged in 1948.[25] Revealingly, Rodinson saw no need to evoke the liberation struggle of Palestinian Jewry against British imperialism in the 1940s—beyond a few pejorative references to Jewish "terrorism."

There was a clear double standard at work in this approach. When Arabs fought the British, that was "anti-colonialism." But if Jews rose up against British policy in Palestine, it was terrorism. Arab nationalism was always "progressive" but Jewish nationalism represented only imperialist reaction. Rodinson had learned this lesson in 1952 when, as a hard-line French Communist, he glorified Soviet policy towards the Jews to the point of justifying Stalin's notoriously antisemitic "Doctors' Plot."[26]

Like most anti-Zionist Jews of his generation, Rodinson saw himself as a de-judaized Jew—one who regarded all forms of nationalism as a "mental illness." What was especially repulsive about Zionism was that it claimed to *represent him*. On the other hand, he felt a strong moral "obligation" towards the Arabs whom Zionism had (allegedly) "robbed of a homeland."

Rodinson borrowed the category of a "non-Jewish Jew" from the Polish-born former Jewish Trotskyite, Isaac Deutscher.[27] In the 1950s, Deutscher had invented this term for "revolutionary" Jews like Spinoza, Freud, Marx, Rosa Luxemburg, and Trotsky, who lived on the "borderlines" of various national cultures, "transcended" Jewry, and created new horizons for the future. Their universal *Weltanschaung* led them to reject traditional Judaism as far too "narrow" and parochial.[28] Deutscher identified himself with these Jewish "heretics," who had correctly grasped that all nation-states (including Israel) were an "anachronism." By June 1967, Deutscher developed a harsh animus against the Israelis, caricaturing them as "the Prussians of the Middle East," imbued with the same "absolute confidence in their arms, chauvinistic arrogance and contempt for other peoples."[29] In his last recorded interview

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Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,